woodturning. This is where his learning really happened. By practising, explaining and demonstrating techniques like rolling a bead, keeping bevel contact etc., he refined his skills. Max began turning items that had no function, at least no traditionally practical function. They were explorations of form, texture and proportion. When he had an idea, he'd produce a series of work, developing and expanding the idea. Some led on to other ideas and resulted in pieces he's proud of, others kept them warm on winter evenings!

Influence and inspiration

"When I was growing up I had the great fortune to have parents who allowed me to develop my own interests and choose my path," Max tells us. Lothar Goebel, a family friend and artist from Germany, had a summer house near the family home. Max would often spend time with Lothar during the summers, collecting beach pebbles and rusty steel for his sculptures from local storm beaches. He would take Max along to art trade shows and galleries to deliver his work. This, along with his encouragement and guidance, exposed Max to what was possible. "My work is a subconscious manifestation of the things that inspire me. I'm drawn towards natural materials, their honesty and the effects that time and use have on them," Max says of his inspirations. "I try to capture the nature of the materials I use in as clean a way as I can."

Max's aim is to reduce the piece down to its bare essentials. Max works in series, each expressing an idea. Sometimes that idea takes the form of a political or social viewpoint, but often it's just an exploration of form and material. The Japanese concept of Wabi-Sabi appeals greatly to Max. The core of this concept is the belief that beauty lies in honest imperfection and that as natural materials age, they gain in beauty.

In terms of woodturning, the turners Max has admired most are Liam Flynn for opening his eyes as to what woodturning could be and his absolute integrity of form and proportion; Glenn Lucas for his phenomenal technical skill; and Ernst Gamperl for his exploration of the properties of green turned large scale vessels.

Ethos

Max's work ethos depends entirely on his motivation. If he's excited and bursting with ideas, then he's up at dawn, developing and creating, however, if Max is working at something monotonous or repetitive, he'll find an excuse to sleep another hour or two. Once Max gets started on a piece, however, excitement takes over and he tells us that he won't stop until he's finished the rough turning and can see the form emerging. Sometimes, Max will even forget to eat for the whole day! Many of the pieces require further work, such as carving and sandblasting, which Max usually does at a later stage.

To promote his work, Max enters competitions and exhibitions and posts his work on his Facebook page (www.facebook.com/maxbrosiwoodturning). Max has also found word-of-mouth to be a great source of promotion 'once people get to know you and your work'.

A working day

Other than the one day a week spent teaching, which results in a regular working day, a typical day for Max is taken up with either turning or working on the house and garden, while in the evening he usually designs and sketches things he wants to turn and make. Max will read something to inspire him or sit in the garden with a beer and the dog! On the weekend creativity isn't too far from Max's mind, as he will go beach-combing with his wife and dog, go sea kayaking, trekking, visit friends and of course, turning wood.

While teaching in the Further Education College, or giving private woodturning tuition, Max's work is planned out carefully and he works to a disciplined schedule.

Style

Over the past two to three years Max has begun to develop a style he recognises as

Irish Water

Split Tube Form

Turbo Form

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